

Even if and even though

Learner workbook

Distinguish a condition from an accepted fact.

Understand the distinction

Even though introduces a fact accepted in the sentence: Even though it was raining, we walked. Even if introduces a condition or possibility that does not change the result: Even if it rains, we will walk.

The if clause does not assert that the condition is true. It can refer to a possibility or something already known in context; its job is conditional. For a likely future condition, normally use present tense after if rather than will.

Compare the patterns

ACCEPTED FACT

Even though I was tired, I stayed.

The speaker says they were tired.

CONDITION

Even if I am tired, I will stay.

The plan holds whether or not I am tired.

CONTRAST

It was expensive, but I bought it.

But can express a simpler contrast.

Read each example and notice how its form changes the meaning. Use these distinctions to choose your answers on the following pages.

Check your understanding

Circle one answer for each question. There is one correct choice among the options shown. Check the answer key after choosing.

1. Which asserts rain occurred: Even if it rained / Even though it rained?

- A. Both phrases assert that it rained.
- B. Even if it rained.
- C. Even though it rained.

2. Complete: Even if she ___ late, we will wait. (arrive)

- A. arriving
- B. arrives
- C. arrive

3. Does Even if the shop is closed, I will go prove it is closed?

- A. No. It proves the shop is open.
- B. No. The closure is treated as a condition.
- C. Yes. Even if asserts that the shop is closed.

Choose the best response

Choose the response that fits the situation. Check both its meaning and its grammar.

4. The weather may be bad, but you will go to class either way. Which sentence expresses that plan?

- A. Even if the weather is bad, I will go to class.
- B. Even though the weather is bad, I will go to class.
- C. If the weather is bad, I will stay home.

Review your choices

Use the answer explanations on the next page. If you chose a different answer, find the detail that makes it unsuitable and try the question again.

Practice online

The web lesson gives feedback for the option you select and lets you try again. No written response is required.

Answers and explanation

1. C. Even though it rained.

Even though presents the rain as a fact.

2. B. arrives

Use present simple for this future condition.

3. B. No. The closure is treated as a condition.

The sentence does not establish its truth.

4. A. Even if the weather is bad, I will go to class.

Even if presents a possible difficulty that will not change the plan.

Continue learning

Web lesson and related topics: englishladder.com/grammar-concepts/concept-32.html